set about acting as the main coordinator behind the scenes, to unite the P-5. It followed the American lead throughout and allowed them to take all the credit. The Chinese efforts to build an international coalition also allowed it to disappear into the crowd. This is a classic diplomatic ruse known as 'Murder with a Borrowed Knife' (*Jie Dao Sha Ren*, a Chinese saying that basically meant shooting off another's shoulders). Inducing others to fight in its stead, in this case America, allowed China to achieve its objective without being at the forefront themselves. This stratagem could also prove useful to subsequently aver that it was someone else's fault if things did not proceed according to plan.

The meeting of the foreign ministers of the five Permanent Members of the UN Security Council (known as P-5) in Geneva, on 4 June 1998, went as per the diplomatic strategy that China had planned. The P-5 laid down five conditions for the lifting of sanctions on India (and Pakistan), namely that both had to sign the CTBT, join in negotiations for a Fissile Material Cut-off Treaty (FMCT), accept a strategic restraint regime on ballistic missiles, agree to tighter export controls on dual-use items, and to resume dialogue on Jammu and Kashmir. Sheltering behind the UN Security Council made it convenient, and also easier, for China to explain why it had agreed to economic sanctions when China's publicly stated position was that economic sanctions were neither acceptable nor effective. China also played up US and Western concerns about a possible nuclear war in South Asia over Kashmir as a consequence of the nuclear weaponization of India. In this whole effort, the Chinese took special care to make sure the United States always stayed in the limelight as the leader, but, as Michael Krepon put it, 'Beijing's imprint on the P-5's conditions was difficult to miss, as the proposed strategic restraint regime and FMCT would significantly constrain India from countering China's strategic